

You're Freaking Out and It Scares Me Too: Understanding How Exposure to Negative Discourse on r/Gradadmissions Affects Anxiety

Ayush Prasad

aup2@illinois.edu

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign
Urbana, Illinois, USA

Sabelle Huang

sabelle2@illinois.edu

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign
Urbana, Illinois, USA

Mingquan Yi

myi22@illinois.edu

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign
Urbana, Illinois, USA

Veda Duddu

vduddu2@illinois.edu

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign
Urbana, Illinois, USA

Abstract

Graduate school admissions represent a high-stakes life transition in which thousands of applicants confront shared deadlines, rejection waves, and funding uncertainties on a common timeline. Increasingly, this collective experience unfolds publicly on Reddit, particularly within r/gradadmissions. Although the subreddit is not organized around mental health support, it exhibits recurring expressions of anxiety and other negative emotions, raising questions about how event-driven distress manifests in non-clinical online spaces and whether broader patterns of platform participation shape emotional vulnerability.

In this paper, we propose a computational study of negative affect dynamics in r/gradadmissions across two admissions cycles spanning August 2023 to July 2025, analyzing over 90,000 posts and 500,000 comments. We measure anxiety, stress, and depression using a validated transfer-learning classifier and empirically identify high-engagement negative discourse events to anchor temporal analyses. Using propensity score matching, Causal Impact modeling, and Difference-in-Differences estimation, we investigate whether anxiety in this community is chronically elevated or event-triggered, and whether community breadth — the diversity of a user's cross-subreddit participation — buffers or amplifies responses to negative events. This work contributes a framework for studying psychological vulnerability in non-clinical, high-stakes online communities, with implications for platform design and mental health intervention.

ACM Reference Format:

Ayush Prasad, Mingquan Yi, Sabelle Huang, and Veda Duddu. 2026. You're Freaking Out and It Scares Me Too: Understanding How Exposure to Negative Discourse on r/Gradadmissions Affects Anxiety. In *Proceedings of*

(*Computational Social Science*). ACM, New York, NY, USA, 6 pages. <https://doi.org/XXXXXXX.XXXXXXX>

1 Introduction

Each year, hundreds of thousands of students navigate the graduate school admissions cycle—a number that has grown consistently, with applications rising 5.6% between 2022 and 2023 alone[4]. Unlike most personal stressors, graduate admissions is structurally synchronous: applicants across the world face the same deadlines, the same rejection waves, and the same funding uncertainties on a shared calendar, experiencing the emotional arc of the cycle collectively rather than in isolation. Increasingly, this collective experience can be witnessed on Reddit. The r/gradadmissions subreddit[16], a Reddit community drawing over 287,000 weekly visitors, has emerged as the primary online space where applicants process the emotional reality of the cycle in real time, not as a mental health forum but as an information and support community where distress is ambient, event-driven, and highly visible — and where users are routinely exposed to others' negative disclosures such as but not limited to rejections, funding losses, and application outcomes.

Existing approaches to studying mental health during high-stakes life events rely predominantly on self-report surveys and clinical instruments, which capture distress only at discrete time points and require institutional access to affected populations [6]. Social media has emerged as a complementary lens, offering continuous, naturalistic behavioral trace data that does not depend on formal help-seeking or institutional affiliation [21]. However, even computational work on Reddit has largely anchored to communities explicitly organized around mental health support—r/anxiety, r/depression—or to geographically-situated campus populations where community membership is a proxy for institutional enrollment [9, 21]. Where cross-community behavior has been studied at all, it has been confined to movements between mental health subreddits [6]. To our knowledge, no work has examined how exposure to negative disclosures within a non-clinical, high-stakes life event community causally affects the mental health of other community members — or whether individual differences in platform participation moderate that effect. Unlike prior settings, users arrive at r/gradadmissions not to seek mental health support, but

Permission to make digital or hard copies of all or part of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for components of this work owned by others than the author(s) must be honored. Abstracting with credit is permitted. To copy otherwise, or republish, to post on servers or to redistribute to lists, requires prior specific permission and/or a fee. Request permissions from permissions@acm.org.

Computational Social Science, March 2026

© 2026 Copyright held by the owner/author(s). Publication rights licensed to ACM.

ACM ISBN 978-x-xxxx-xxxx-x/YYYY/MM

<https://doi.org/XXXXXXX.XXXXXXX>

to access information and solidarity around a shared, high-stakes life event. Yet because the event itself is uncertain, competitive, and temporally bounded, anxiety appears to be a recurring feature of the discourse—ambient in the discourse rather than declared in the purpose. This makes the community a useful setting for studying how event-driven anxiety emerges and propagates through non-clinical online spaces.

We draw on the stress buffering hypothesis [3], which holds that access to diverse social resources attenuates the psychological impact of stressors. We operationalize this behaviorally through community breadth, defined as the number of distinct subreddits a user participates in beyond *r/gradadmissions*. Users with broader cross-platform participation may draw on more varied informational and emotional support networks, buffering them against distress triggered by negative disclosures. Conversely, users concentrated in *r/gradadmissions* may face a narrower, more uniformly distressing information environment, amplifying the effect of negative events. Toward these goals, we ask three research questions:

- RQ1:** Does exposure to high-engagement negative disclosure posts increase mental health distress across anxiety, depression, and stress in exposed users relative to matched unexposed users?
- RQ2:** Does community breadth moderate this effect, such that higher-breadth users show attenuated distress responses consistent with the stress buffering hypothesis?

To answer these questions, we analyze 91,000 posts and 501,000 comments from *r/gradadmissions* spanning two complete admissions cycles (August 2023 – July 2025). We measure mental health using validated transfer-learning classifiers for anxiety, depression, and stress [21], empirically identify high-engagement negative discourse events as causal anchors, and apply propensity score matching with Causal Impact and Difference-in-Differences modeling to estimate the causal effect of anchor post exposure on subsequent mental health trajectories, with community breadth as a moderator.

This work makes three contributions. First, we provide one of the first causal estimates of how exposure to negative disclosure in a non-clinical, high-stakes life event community, across anxiety, depression, and stress dimensions, in a non-clinical, high-stakes online community. Second, we contribute a methodological framework for studying event-driven anxiety in observational social media data, extending quasi-experimental causal inference approaches developed in prior computational social science work to a new class of online community. Third, our findings carry practical implications for platform design and community moderation — if community breadth shapes vulnerability to distress contagion during high-stakes life events, this suggests intervention points for identifying and supporting at-risk users not only in graduate admissions contexts but in any online community organized around consequential life transitions.

2 Related Work

2.1 Mental Health on Social Media

Existing approaches to assessing mental health rely predominantly on self-report surveys and clinical instruments, which are susceptible to social desirability bias and underreporting, and capture

psychological states only at discrete timepoints, missing the fine-grained, real-time fluctuations in distress that characterize high-stakes life events [23]. Social media has emerged as a complementary passive sensor, offering continuous, naturalistic behavioral trace data that does not depend on formal help-seeking or institutional affiliation [2, 6]. A growing body of work has applied quantitative NLP methods to predict mental health status from social media language, including depression, anxiety, stress, and suicidal ideation, though concerns around construct validity and methodological standardization remain [2]. Reddit in particular has been established as a rich data source for mental health research: its pseudonymous design lowers barriers to candid self-disclosure around stigmatized topics, and its community structure enables individuals to seek and provide emotional, informational, and prescriptive support [5]. Building on this foundation, transfer learning classifiers trained on Reddit mental health communities have been shown to identify symptomatic mental health expressions with high accuracy and have been validated against ground-truth data of on-campus mental health service utilization [19, 21]. These methods have further been extended to quasi-experimental settings to capture the temporal evolution of mental health in response to external events, including the COVID-19 pandemic on college campuses [18]. Our work draws on this literature by applying validated transfer learning classifiers [19] to measure anxiety expressions in *r/gradadmissions*, extending these methods to a non-clinical, event-driven community.

2.2 Life Transitions, High Stakes Events, and Online Support Communities

Shifts in role, identity or social context have been known to disrupt established routines. These have been associated with elevated psychological distress, particularly when time bound and outcome uncertain [14]. Wendlandt and Rochlen further identified anticipation, the pre-resolution stage of such life transitions as particularly taxing as individual remain suspended between roles without psychological relief of a known outcome [25]. Graduate admissions exists well within this framework as it is a prospective, high stake event tied to career trajectory, self concept and in many cases immigration status. The events of this cycle unfold over months of structured uncertainty with no institutional mental health scaffolding.

Substantial body of work has examined how individuals turn to online communities to fill this gap. Burke and Kraut showed that directed social media communications with close ties reduces stress during transitions such as job loss, though passive consumption confers no such benefit [1]. DeAndrea et al. found that students leverage social media during the high school to college transition to access peer communities in the absence of existing infrastructure [7]. Gong et al. extended this to the post-college transition, finding that Reddit users seek informational, emotional, and decision-making support during this period, with stress exhibiting clear temporal seasonality across topics [9]. Similar dynamics have been observed in other high stake academic communities including but not limited to medical licensing exam subreddits [12]. Haimson further theorizes that individuals in transition distribute support-seeking across multiple platforms simultaneously, each serving distinct social functions—a

framing that motivates community breadth as a meaningful behavioral variable [10].

However, online communities are not uniformly protective. Yin et al. found that Reddit support seeking can both relieve and exacerbate distress, with criticism and support mismatches actively increasing stress for some users [26]. This aligns with evidence that negative content spreads more persistently than positive in online spaces, and communities organized around shared distress can amplify rather than buffer negative emotional states [?]. Whether graduate admissions discourse chronically elevates anxiety or triggers acute spikes around specific negative events, and whether a user's broader online ecosystem moderates their vulnerability, are questions the life transitions literature has not addressed computationally. Our work aims to address this gap.

2.3 Community Breadth and Cross-Community Participation

Reddit users vary considerably in how concentrated or distributed their activity is across subreddits. Tan and Lee established that multi-community engagement is the norm on Reddit, with users continuously dispersing their activity across an increasingly diverse set of communities over time rather than settling into a single home community [22]. Waller and Anderson formalized this as a generalist-specialist spectrum, finding that generalists engage with more diverse social networks while specialists contribute higher-quality content within their communities [24]. This variation in cross-community participation has theoretical grounding in social capital research: breadth of online engagement is associated with bridging social capital—weak ties that provide access to diverse informational and emotional resources beyond one's immediate community [8].

Prior work has begun to examine how participation patterns relate to mental health discourse specifically. Morini et al. found that behavioral patterns differ markedly between mental health subreddits and general-interest communities, and that community response causally shapes whether users continue engaging [15]. However, this work examines variation between mental health communities rather than asking how a user's broader activity across non-mental-health subreddits shapes their psychological experience within a single community. We address this gap by examining whether community breadth moderates anxiety during a high-stakes life event — connecting the multi-community behavior literature to mental health outcomes in a non-clinical context for the first time.

3 Data

3.1 Platform and Community

To study anxiety expression during graduate admissions, we focus on r/gradadmissions, a Reddit community dedicated to discussion of the graduate school application process. Reddit is a natural setting for this inquiry: users routinely share personal context to receive relevant peer advice, producing naturalistic, first-person discourse that captures lived experience without the social desirability constraints of surveys [5]. r/gradadmissions, in particular, follows a recurring annual cycle — activity rises sharply in the fall as application deadlines approach, peaks between December and February as

decisions are released, and subsides by May as cycles conclude. This temporal structure makes it well-suited for studying how anxiety unfolds across a high-stakes life event.

3.2 Data Collection

We collect data from r/gradadmissions spanning two full application cycles: August 1, 2023 to May 31, 2025. Data is retrieved using Arctic Shift [11], a publicly available Reddit archive tool. Pulling all self-text posts and their associated comments yields approximately 91k posts and 501k comments. We then filter out link posts and bot comments to focus on narrative, first-person expressions where anxiety is most likely to surface. For each unique author in the dataset, we shall additionally pull their posting activity across all subreddits during the same window using Arctic Shift's user activity endpoint. All usernames will be anonymized prior to analysis.

3.3 Ethical Considerations

This study relies solely on publicly accessible Reddit data. All usernames are pseudonymized prior to analysis; no personally identifiable information is retained. Consistent with prior computational social science research using public Reddit data [5, 17], this study does not involve human subjects interaction and qualifies for exempt status under institutional review guidelines.

4 Methods

4.1 Measurement of Negative Affect

To measure mental health distress in posts and comments, we apply three transfer-learning classifiers targeting anxiety, depression, and stress respectively. Each is an SVM model with a linear kernel using n -gram features ($n = 1, 2, 3$), trained on the corresponding mental health subreddit (r/anxiety, r/depression, r/stress) as the positive class and general Reddit posts as the negative class, using the Reddit Mental Health Dataset [13] as the training corpus. The anxiety classifier follows Saha et al.[20] and has been validated against ground-truth mental health service utilization data[21]; the depression and stress classifiers follow the same paradigm from Low et al.[13]. Each post and comment receives a binary label per dimension, and user-level distress is operationalized as the mean classifier score within a given time window.

4.2 Operationalizing Community Breadth

For each unique author in the dataset, we retrieve their posting activity across all subreddits during the study window (August 1, 2023–May 31, 2025) via Arctic Shift's user activity endpoint. Community breadth is then defined as the number of distinct subreddits a user posted in *outside* r/gradadmissions during this period. This operationalization captures the diversity of a user's online social engagement: users with high breadth maintain active participation across multiple communities, while users with low breadth are concentrated almost entirely in r/gradadmissions. We treat community breadth as a continuous variable throughout. In our causal models, community breadth serves as a moderator rather than a primary predictor, testing whether it conditions the effect of anchor post exposure on distress.

4.3 Identifying Anchor Events

We define *anchor posts* as posts containing negative admissions-related disclosures, identified empirically in two steps. First, we filter posts using keywords associated with negative admissions experiences, such as rejections, funding loss, and declining acceptance rates. Second, among filtered posts, we apply our distress classifiers and retain only those scoring above a threshold on at least one of the three dimensions (anxiety, depression, or stress). A user is classified as *exposed* if they posted at least one comment within the thread of an anchor post. A user is classified as *unexposed* if they were active in r/gradadmissions during the same week, defined as posting at least one comment or post in the subreddit, but did not engage with the anchor post thread. This ensures both groups were present and active in the community at the time of the event, isolating thread engagement as the source of differential exposure.

4.4 Analysis

RQ 1 (effect of anchor post exposure): We will apply propensity score matching followed by a Difference-in-Differences model comparing distress scores in the two weeks before and after anchor post exposure between matched exposed and unexposed users, estimated separately for each distress dimension.

RQ2 (community breadth as moderator): We will add an interaction term exposure $\times$ community breadth to the DiD model. A negative coefficient would support the stress buffering hypothesis; a positive coefficient would support the amplification hypothesis. All analyses will be replicated across both application cycles (2023–24 and 2024–25) to assess temporal stability.

5 Preliminary Results and Analysis

We conducted an analysis of 2,235 posts from r/gradadmissions during September 2024 to identify the dominant themes present in posts, allowing us to determine what applicants most frequently discuss during the admissions cycle (e.g., funding uncertainty, interview timelines, rejection notifications). Using Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) with five most relevant topics, we have identified several primary discourse clusters, including PhD program planning, MS program considerations, profile evaluation, GPA/GRE concerns. With the intertopic distance map, we revealed a dominant research-oriented theme making up approximately 29.5% of corpus token. These findings suggested that during the early stages of admission cycle, users tend to focus more on their applications rather than results.

Separately, we conducted sentiment analysis to estimate the polarity of posts. Sentiment scores range from negative to positive values, allowing us to assess whether discourse trends negative, positive, or neutral over time. However, from our finding through VADER, the general discourse was positive (72.6% positive, 13% negative). From our analysis, we found that discussions centered on GPA and standardized test performances had the lowest average compound sentiment, as well as the highest proportion of negative posts. Unfortunately, we were not able to find a direct relation with the sentiment and related topics being discussed. We believe that that we would have to shift our methods a little to find the problem that could cause potential anxiety.

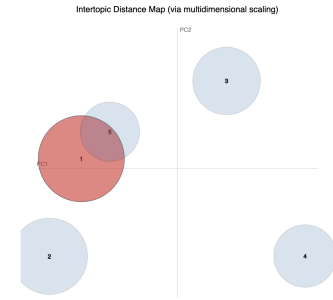


Figure 1: Intertopic distance map for September 2024 r/gradadmissions posts

6 Preliminary Feedback

Our initial research direction focused on semantic analysis within r/gradadmissions, examining how temporal events and cultural background (international versus domestic applicants) shaped anxiety trajectories. Specifically, we proposed:

- **RQ1:** How do anxiety patterns differ between graduate applicants who concentrate their online activity exclusively in r/gradadmissions versus those active across multiple communities?
- **RQ2:** How are these patterns shaped by cultural context (international versus domestic applicants)?
- **RQ3:** How do they evolve across temporal cycles—both within a single admissions season and for users who persist across multiple application years?

Our original plan involved identifying user activity patterns across Reddit, performing longitudinal tracking across admissions cycles, implementing cultural classification through linguistic markers (e.g., British vs. American spelling, non-native English indicators, currency references, TOEFL/IELTS mentions), and measuring anxiety through multiple lexical and sentiment tools (e.g., VADER, BERT, LIWC), alongside temporal alignment with major world events.

Preliminary feedback encouraged us to narrow the scope of our research questions and more clearly articulate RQ novelty relative to existing literature. Concerns were raised regarding the validity and reliability of inferring cultural identity from linguistic markers, as well as the robustness of our proposed anxiety measurement framework. Peer feedback also centered around how anxiety would be quantified and measured.

In response, we pivoted away from using cultural markers for classification and refined our focus towards community breadth as a measurable behavioral feature. Our revised approach examines how cross-subreddit participation informs anxiety trajectories during high-engagement negative discourse events. We plan to employ an anxiety classifier, identify empirically grounded negative discourse anchors, and apply propensity score matching, Causal Impact modeling, and Difference-in-Differences analysis to estimate event-driven effects stratified by user community breadth.

RP-4: Originally we planned to just measure anxiety, but have now broadened this to cover a wider range of negative emotions,

like depression and stress as well. We group these emotions into a broad category of "negative affect".

7 Contribution Statement

Veda led the initial development of the project and wrote the paper outline. She refined the research questions, shaped the overall analytical strategy, and guided the team's research direction and plan of attack for data analysis. Veda authored the Introduction and Related Work sections and drafted the initial methodology framework that informed subsequent stages of the project.

Sabelle collaborated closely with Veda in developing and expanding the research methodology and contributed to early-stage writing. She led the creation of presentation materials for the research project pitch and project check-ins, ensuring clear articulation of the RQ/Why/How framework and incorporation of feedback. Sabbelle wrote the Abstract section and supported initial data collection efforts.

Ayush led the initial data exploration and pre-processing phase. He cleaned the initial r/gradadmissions dataset to be used for data analysis.

Ming was responsible for collecting the r/gradadmissions dataset from ArcticShift and ensuring the data was accessible for analysis. He supported dataset cleaning efforts alongside Ayush and assisted Sabbelle in preparing presentations. Ming performed preliminary topic and semantic analysis of the dataset.

All team members collaborated on revising the paper, incorporating feedback from instructors and peers. Looking forward, the project load will continue be shared among all group members, and everyone will contribute to paper writing, data analysis, and background research (data, papers, etc.) such that no one person is shouldering any task alone. In the final paper, we will follow a similar outline structure to the Research Project document, but everyone will expand more on data analysis, insights, and future use cases of the research.

8 Future Timeline

We target a poster presentation in the first week of May, leaving approximately nine weeks for data processing, analysis, and writing. Table 1 outlines the proposed schedule.

References

- [1] Moira Burke and Robert Kraut. 2013. Using Facebook after losing a job: Differential benefits of strong and weak ties. In *Proceedings of the 2013 conference on Computer supported cooperative work*. 1419–1430.
- [2] Stevie Chancellor and Munmun De Choudhury. 2020. Methods in predictive techniques for mental health status on social media: a critical review. *NPJ digital medicine* 3, 1 (2020), 43.
- [3] Sheldon Cohen and Thomas A Wills. 1985. Stress, social support, and the buffering hypothesis. *Psychological bulletin* 98, 2 (1985), 310.
- [4] Council of Graduate Schools. 2024. *Graduate Enrollment and Degrees: 2013 to 2023*. Technical Report. Council of Graduate Schools. <https://cgsnet.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/12/GED-2024-1.1.pdf>
- [5] Munmun De Choudhury and Sushovan De. 2014. Mental health discourse on reddit: Self-disclosure, social support, and anonymity. In *Proceedings of the international AAAI conference on web and social media*, Vol. 8. 71–80.
- [6] Munmun De Choudhury, Michael Gamon, Scott Counts, and Eric Horvitz. 2013. Predicting depression via social media. In *Proceedings of the international AAAI conference on web and social media*, Vol. 7. 128–137.
- [7] David C DeAndrea, Nicole B Ellison, Robert LaRose, Charles Steinfield, and Andrew Fiore. 2012. Serious social media: On the use of social media for improving students' adjustment to college. *The Internet and higher education* 15, 1 (2012), 15–23.

Table 1: Project timeline (March 2 – April 30, 2026).

Weeks	Dates	Tasks
1–2	Mar 2–14	Finalize anchor event thresholds; run LDA and VADER on full corpus; pull community breadth data via Arctic Shift
3–4	Mar 15–28	Run anxiety classifier on all posts and comments; compute user-level mean anxiety scores; sanity check against expected seasonal pattern
5–6	Mar 29–Apr 11	RQ1: OLS regression; RQ2: time series and change point detection; RQ3: interaction model replicated across both cycles
7	Apr 12–18	Generate poster figures; write results section
8	Apr 19–25	Write discussion section; produce poster draft
9	Apr 26–30	Revisions, advisor feedback, and poster finalization

- [8] Nicole B Ellison, Charles Steinfield, and Cliff Lampe. 2007. The benefits of Facebook "friends": Social capital and college students' use of online social network sites. *Journal of computer-mediated communication* 12, 4 (2007), 1143–1168.
- [9] Crystal Gong, Koustuv Saha, and Stevie Chancellor. 2021. "The Smartest Decision for My Future": social media reveals challenges and stress during post-college life transition. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 5, CSCW2 (2021), 1–29.
- [10] Oliver Haimson. 2018. Social media as social transition machinery. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 2, CSCW (2018), 1–21.
- [11] Arthur Heitmann. 2023. Arctic Shift: Making Reddit Data Accessible to Researchers, Moderators and Everyone Else. <https://arctic-shift.photon-reddit.com>. Accessed: 2026.
- [12] Michael R Kann, David Chen, Grace W Huang, Sangami Pugazenthi, and Nicholas G Zehnder. 2025. A medical student online community: A qualitative analysis of step 1 subreddit posts. *Medical Science Educator* 35, 1 (2025), 425–436.
- [13] Daniel M Low, Laurie Rumker, John Torous, Guillermo Cecchi, Satrajit S Ghosh, and Tanya Talkar. 2020. Natural Language Processing Reveals Vulnerable Mental Health Support Groups and Heightened Health Anxiety on Reddit During COVID-19: Observational Study. *Journal of medical Internet research* 22, 10 (2020), e22635.
- [14] Jude P Mikal, Ronald E Rice, Audrey Abeyta, and Jenica DeVilbiss. 2013. Transition, stress and computer-mediated social support. *Computers in Human Behavior* 29, 5 (2013), A40–A53.
- [15] Virginia Morini, Maria Sansoni, Giulio Rossetti, Dino Pedreschi, and Carlos Castillo. 2025. Participant behavior and community response in online mental health communities: Insights from Reddit. *Computers in Human Behavior* 165 (2025), 108544.
- [16] r/gradadmissions. 2026. r/gradadmissions subreddit. <https://www.reddit.com/r/gradadmissions>. Accessed February 28, 2026.
- [17] Koustuv Saha and Munmun De Choudhury. 2017. Modeling stress with social media around incidents of gun violence on college campuses. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 1, CSCW (2017), 1–27.
- [18] Koustuv Saha, Bhaskar Kotakonda, and Munmun De Choudhury. 2025. Mental Health Impact of the COVID-19 Pandemic on College Students: A Quasi-Experimental Study on Social Media. In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, Vol. 19. 1748–1770.
- [19] Koustuv Saha, Benjamin Sugar, John Torous, Bruno Abrahao, Emre Kiciman, and Munmun De Choudhury. 2019. A social media study on the effects of psychiatric medication use. In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, Vol. 13. 440–451.
- [20] Koustuv Saha, John Torous, Sindhu Kiranmai Ernala, Conor Rizuto, Amanda Stafford, and Munmun De Choudhury. 2019. A computational study of mental health awareness campaigns on social media. *Translational behavioral medicine* 9, 6 (2019), 1197–1207.
- [21] Koustuv Saha, Asra Yousuf, Ryan L Boyd, James W Pennebaker, and Munmun De Choudhury. 2022. Social media discussions predict mental health consultations on college campuses. *Scientific reports* 12, 1 (2022), 123.
- [22] Chenhao Tan and Lillian Lee. 2015. All who wander: On the prevalence and characteristics of multi-community engagement. In *Proceedings of the 24th International Conference on World Wide Web*. 1056–1066.

- [23] Roger Tourangeau, Lance J Rips, and Kenneth Rasinski. 2000. The psychology of survey response. (2000).
- [24] Isaac Waller and Ashton Anderson. 2019. Generalists and specialists: Using community embeddings to quantify activity diversity in online platforms. In *The World Wide Web Conference*. 1954–1964.
- [25] Nancy M Wendlandt and Aaron B Rochlen. 2008. Addressing the college-to-work transition: Implications for university career counselors. *Journal of Career Development* 35, 2 (2008), 151–165.
- [26] Jiayu Yuki Yin, Novia Wong, and Madhu Reddy. 2025. Understanding User Experience of Support-Seeking on Reddit During Stressful Times. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 9, 7 (2025), 1–25.